

JULY 1-15, 1979

The Q Factor

The prime minister saying that Quattrocchi has been harassed is a very shocking statement ("The Smoking Gun", May 11). The CBI was used for covering up and giving a clean chit to 'Q' who had a close relationship with Rajiv Gandhi and Sonia. In the process, the CBI has also earned the notorious distinction of being the 'Congress Bureau of Investigation' and has lost its credibility as an impartial investigating agency.

A. SRIKANTIAH, *Bangalore*

The clean chit to Quattrocchi may be legally sound but is against the popular public perception that sees him guilty. It is similar to the exoneration of Sajjan Kumar and Jagdish Tytler in the anti-Sikh riots. The timing of a disclosure is also important. Defending Quattrocchi at this moment is likely to hurt the prospects of the Congress in the elections.

R.J. KHURANA,

via www.indiatoday.in

Golden Childhood

Educated parents with talented children chug them along the TV/movie sets, making them cram lessons between shots, earning them an honourable mention in the media ("TV's Fresh Face", May 4). On the other hand, children who are less fortunate and would like to be employed to augment their family in-

come are shown as child labourers and their parents as exploiters. This speaks volumes about the double standards in our society.

ANAND MADABHUSHI,

via www.indiatoday.in

Strange Bedfellows

Electoral promiscuity has reached bizarre heights ("The Front Runners", May 4). The Left is enticing other regional parties by creating illusions that every leader has an equal chance for the top job.

rank in the list of most corrupt nations ("Buy One Get Two", April 27). Even as dynastic promoters are busy marketing him, old and new sycophants in the fold openly want Rahul Gandhi for the top post, indirectly hinting that Manmohan is only a stop-gap arrangement.

DR. HIMAL CHAND, *Chandigarh*

Aligned Moves

The political scenario emerging from the declaration of independence by



“ This kind of ephemeral hullabaloo for merged power only makes the case for a two-party system in our country stronger. ‘Quantity democracy’ will only destroy India. ”

K. CHIDANAND KUMAR, *Bangalore*

While the BJP seems to be in high spirits, the Congress is in dire straits with its former allies behaving strangely.

H.R. SATYANARAYANA, *Mysore*

Seat-Warmer

Manmohan Singh might have great achievements to his credit, but India was globally dishonoured during his tenure when it slipped from 72nd to 85th

alliance partners, mostly of the Congress party, calls to mind the NAM phenomenon ("The Great Prime Minister Bazaar", April 13). The regional parties, presently euphoric in the rhetoric of third/fourth fronts, will go to one or the other national party depending on inducements.

BISHAN SAHAI,

via www.indiatoday.in

The New Power Game

The month of June certainly signified the darkest chapter in the brief but tortuous history of the Janata Party. It was a month when political temperatures soared along with the mercury, ushering in dangerous portents. A month in which the protracted power game took a malevolent turn. It was also a month plagued with ironies. Raj Narain, the irascible political gadfly who acquired the status of a national leader by trouncing Indira Gandhi first in the courts and then at the hustings in March 1977, and one of the founders of the Janata Party, has quit the party. Thus, unwittingly placing his political mentor, deputy prime minister Charan Singh, in the predicament of whether to follow suit or hold fire. Meanwhile, the Janata Party's main political rival—the Congress (I)—staged its own drama. Karnataka chief minister Devraj Urs, picked by Mrs Gandhi as her political handmaiden in Karnataka, dumped her to launch his own party.

Arun B. Louis, Dilip Bobb and Amarnath K. Menon



CHARAN SINGH
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